

The Magic Cardboard Box

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



A big cardboard box arrived at Dara's house.

It had held a new lamp.

Now it was empty.

Dara climbed inside.

"It is just a box," he said.

He felt a little bored.

Then his sister Zoya had an idea.

"What if it is not just a box?" she whispered.

She felt mischievous.

She drew a round window on the side.

She drew buttons and dials.

"It is a rocket!" she declared.

Dara's eyes went wide.

He felt excited.



"Five, four, three, two, one," they counted together.

"Blast off!"

They zoomed to the moon.

They waved at the stars.

"Again, again, again!" shouted Dara.

That was three times he shouted it.

He felt thrilled.

Then Zoya flipped the box over.

She drew a steering wheel.

"It is a race car now!" she said.

Vroom, vroom, went Dara.

He raced around the living room.

He won the big race.

He felt proud.

Then their mama joined in.



She cut a door in the box.

"It is a cozy house," she said.

Dara and Zoya crawled inside.

Mama brought cushions.

They had a picnic in the box house.

Yum, yum, went their pretend sandwiches.

Dara felt happy.

One box had been three things.

A rocket.

A race car.

A cozy house.

"What will it be tomorrow?" asked Dara.

"Anything," said Zoya.

"Anything, anything, anything," she said.

That was three times she said it.

Dara felt amazed.



A box could be anything.

As the evening came, Dara curled up in the box house.

It was small and warm.

It smelled like cardboard and crayons.

He yawned.

Zoya yawned too.

Mama covered them with a blanket.

Sleep now, little dreamers.

Dream of boxes that become anything at all.

Moral: *The best toys are the ones your imagination builds.*

The End